START HERE / SIMPLE USER MANUAL

UniFind

Team Guide: From First Login to Item Return

A short guide for students (finders and owners) and university counter staff. Use this for team testing and class demonstrations.

WHAT IS UNIFIND?

A campus noticeboard for FOUND items only. Students report items they found. Someone who recognises their item can request to collect it. No Lost Item report or automatic matching is required.

1 Start the website in VS Code

1	**Open the project** In VS Code, choose File > Open Folder and select the folder containing server.py (it may still be named CampusBack).
2	**Open a terminal** Choose Terminal > New Terminal.
3	**Create demo accounts (first run only)** Type python seed_demo.py, then press Enter. Skip this step when using a database that already contains your data.
4	**Start UniFind** Type python server.py and press Enter. Keep the terminal running.
5	**Open the website** In Chrome or Edge, type http://localhost:8000 in the address bar.

IMPORTANT

UniFind is running locally. Other devices cannot open localhost:8000 unless you set up network access or hosting. The project folder and terminal may still say CampusBack; the web interface is called UniFind.

2 Demo login accounts

Account	Email	Password
Sara — student	sara@campus.test	Demo1234!
Daniel — student	daniel@campus.test	Demo1234!
Office counter staff	counter@campus.test	Demo1234!

STUDENTS / THE MAIN SCREENS

3 Where should I click?

Screen	Who uses it?	Purpose
Community	Everyone	Browse available Found Items. Click a card to view its photo and details.
+ Report Found Item	A student who finds an item	Post a found item so others can see it.
My Activity → I Want to Collect	Student claiming an item (Owner)	Track requests and collection progress.
My Activity → Items I Found	Student who posted an item (Finder)	Manage requests for items you found, and see your posts.
Counter Desk	Office staff only	Record item receipt and final collection at a selected counter.

4 How to report a Found Item (Finder)

1	**Log in** Use your student account. Click + Report Found Item.
2	**Enter item information** Add item name, category, colour, found location, date and description. Add a photo if available.
3	**Add a private question** Write a security question and secret answer. Choose the preferred campus counter.
4	**Publish** Click Publish Found Item. Your item appears in Community and in My Activity → Items I Found.

SAFETY TIP

Do not write the private answer, student ID, phone number or sensitive item details in the public description. Finder contact details are shared privately only after an accepted meetup.

5 How to request your item (Owner)

1	**Find the item** Open Community and search or browse the Found Items cards.
2	**Check its details** Click the item card to see its photo, location, description and person who found it.
3	**Choose a method** Click Request to Collect My Item and select Meet the Finder OR Collect at Campus Counter.
4	**Follow progress** Open My Activity → I Want to Collect. The app shows the next step.

OPTION A / MEET THE FINDER

6 Meet the Finder: full example

Example: Daniel found a wallet. Sara recognises it as hers. They choose to meet in person.

1	**Sara (Owner) sends request** Community → Black Wallet → Request to Collect My Item → Meet the Finder.
2	**Sara checks the request** My Activity → I Want to Collect shows Waiting for finder reply.
3	**Daniel (Finder) responds** Daniel logs in → My Activity → Items I Found → Accept meetup or Decline with reason.
4	**If accepted: arrange meetup** Sara can see Daniel's shared contact details. They arrange a safe place to meet outside the app.
5	**Sara makes the final decision** After receiving the wallet, Sara clicks I've Collected My Item. The request moves to Completed History. Daniel does not confirm again.

7 What if the meetup does not work?

Situation	What happens next
Daniel is not on campus / unavailable	He chooses a reason for declining. Sara sees it and may Wait for Finder, Switch to Campus Counter (security question required), or Cancel.
Daniel believes Sara is not the owner	He declines with Not the Owner. The request is rejected, and the item becomes available in Community again.
Sara meets Daniel, but wallet is not hers	Sara clicks This is not my item. The request closes, and the wallet returns to available Found Items.

REMEMBER

For an accepted meetup, Finder accepts once. Owner confirms collection once. Do not mark an item as collected before it is physically received.

OPTION B / CAMPUS COUNTER

8 Collect at Campus Counter: full example

Example: Daniel found white earbuds. Sara requests collection through the office counter.

1	**Sara (Owner) requests counter collection** Community → White Wireless Earbuds → Request to Collect My Item → Collect at Campus Counter.
2	**Sara answers the security question** Enter the finder's private answer. For this demo item, use Blue. Wrong answer = error message and no new request.
3	**Daniel (Finder) brings the item** My Activity → Items I Found → bring the actual earbuds to the selected counter → click I've Submitted This Item.
4	**Staff confirms physical receipt** Staff logs in → Counter Desk → select counter → Step 2 Confirm physical receipt → Confirm Item Received.
5	**Sara collects it** Sara sees that it is ready in My Activity → I Want to Collect and visits the office with student ID and other ownership evidence.
6	**Staff closes the case** After handing the item to Sara, staff clicks Confirm Owner Collected. The record moves to completed history.

9 How office staff read the Counter Desk

Counter Desk section	Meaning	Staff action
Step 1 — Finder preparing item	Finder has not submitted the physical item yet.	Wait. Do not confirm.
Step 2 — Confirm physical receipt	Finder says the item was delivered.	Check actual item; click Confirm Item Received.
Step 3 — Release to owner	Item is held at the counter.	Check identity and ownership; hand over; click Confirm Owner Collected.
Counter collection history	Collection completed or rejected.	Review records, not duplicate items.

Staff may filter the Counter Desk by Student Affairs Office, Library Counter, Security Office, or All counters.

TEAM PRACTICE / TROUBLESHOOTING

10 5-minute team demonstration

Demo	Who signs in?	What to show
1. Post a found item	Daniel (Student)	Report Found Item → item appears in Community.
2. Meet Finder	Sara, then Daniel, then Sara	Sara requests meetup → Daniel accepts → Sara confirms receipt.
3. Counter collection	Sara, Daniel, Counter Staff	Sara verifies → Daniel submits → staff receives → staff releases.
4. History and status	Each person	My Activity or Counter Desk now shows a completed record.

11 Common problems and quick fixes

Problem	Try this
Website does not open	Make sure python server.py is still running in VS Code. Then open http://localhost:8000.
Demo password says incorrect	Use the correct email and Demo1234! (capital D, exclamation mark). For a fresh demo database, run python seed_demo.py once, then restart the server.
No found items appear	You may have an empty database. Log in as a student and publish one Found Item. Demo items are seeded only on setup.
I cannot find a button	Check which account is logged in and choose the matching My Activity tab. Staff actions only appear in Counter Desk.
Counter items are missing	Select All counters, then check the correct step. An item may still be waiting for the finder.
Changes do not appear	Press Ctrl + Shift + R in the browser. Restart the server if the Python files changed.

12 Final reminders

- UniFind only publishes FOUND item reports. There is no Lost Item reporting page.
- Only the finder can accept/decline their meetup requests; only the owner confirms a successful meetup.
- Only counter staff can confirm receipt and release of counter-held items.
- The same item may appear in different users' activity/history views because they share one case, not because it was reported twice.
- For classroom demonstrations, use demo accounts and sample items. Do not publish real private information or use the prototype as a public service without additional security.